On a Mission

Building *6,000 Homes* for the Homeless



> **Charity knows no boundaries of region, color, sex, language, religion or race. In fact, I believe that poverty is the single biggest religion in the world. Towards that extent, the foundation today supports projects across regions irrespective of religion or race.**

As India readied itself for the 2010 Commonwealth games, the Delhi Government demolished the slums on the banks of the Yamuna Pushta and moved approximately 150,000 inhabitants to Bawana, creating J.J. (Jhuggi Jhopri) Colony in Bawana - the second largest slum area in the Asian sub-continent after Dharavi. This is the story of those 40,000 families who were thrown out of Yamuna Pushta and banished to Bawana Village – 40 kilometers away. While the administration shunned its unprivileged lot, the homeless dwellers struggled to live. No civic amenities, no sanitation, no medical facilities, no head on their roof and no means of livelihood, which meant an invitation to depravity. Seems like another sad exploitation story? Wait, there is a twist to the tale - this is an inspirational story of what can be achieved if we as Indians have the resolve to make a difference on our own without any government participation.

Cut to 2003. On a routine business visit to India, Robin Raina - Chairman of EbixCash Limited, walked up to the 5th floor of one of his offices in India. As he absent-mindedly looked at the area around the building, he realized that his office was surrounded by slums at the back. Tears engulfed him and he became inconsolable. What apparently tore his heart apart was not just the poverty in the slums, but his own inability to have noticed the same over the years. He reportedly said "I have been so caught up in my materialistic pursuits that I have lost the ability to see life clearly. I only see what I want to see. As I reflected more on what I saw and tried to think about my own life, I realized that even though I had built a so-called successful business, it did not guarantee happiness to me irrespective of who I was or how much I had. I thought I had built security, I thought I had built success. *But in reality, what I had built was an illusion.* I realized that no one ever really has security or success unless it comes from within one's own self. That was when I promised myself that the next thing I build; no one would be able to take away the associated guaranteed happiness from me. I decided that I wanted to be in the business of imparting and spreading happiness. And the Robin Raina Foundation was born!"

Robin Raina Foundation (RRF), was born on that day and since then, the story changed for the slum dwellers of J.J. Colony, Bawana – Robin conceptualized a project to build 6,000 new concrete homes – *free of cost* for the slum

Self-Made Serial Entrepreneur and Social Innovator

Robin Raina, Chairman & Founder, EbixCash believes that he is in the business of spreading happiness. A passionate patriot, whose heart beats for India in spite of being a NRI; Robin wants to ameliorate the underprivileged and dispossessed masses in India. For Robin, the journey of RRF is one of personal sacrifice and spreading love and happiness. For example, a blind School pass out from RRF becomes a Manager in Allahabad Bank or another student attains a Doctorate from prestigious University and many such examples – these and many such instances make the effort worthwhile. He often says, "Coffin does not have a pocket, so you might as well enjoy the joy of giving in your own lifetime."